

THE AVENGERS IN THE 1980s

WHEN THE 1980s BEGAN, Iron Man was chairman and the Avengers were made up of Ms. Marvel, Captain America, Scarlet Witch, Vision, Wasp, Beast and Falcon. Scripter David Michelinie and penciler John Byrne started the new decade with a battle with the Grey Gargoyle, one of Thor's old villains. Roger Stern and Al Milgrom took over the creative chores in 1983 as the new Captain Marvel joined the team and Hank Pym left.

After a successful four-issue tryout, the West Coast Avengers were awarded their own title in 1985 which was written by Steve Englehart and drawn by Al Milgrom. John Buscema returned to pencil the regular Avengers title and the team took a trip the Savage Land.

As the decade progressed, we learned that there was more than one Kang running around the multiverse, and the new Baron Zemo invaded the Avengers' Mansion. A third Avengers title was launched in 1987, initially called Solo Avengers, but later renamed Avengers Spotlight. It featured a lead Hawkeye story followed by solo stories of the various Avengers. The team were involved in Inferno, a major crossover that ran across the entire line of Marvel titles in 1988, and they followed this adventure with Evolutionary War. As the decade drew to a close, John Byrne took over the art and writing of the West Coast book and was joined on the East Coast title by penciler Paul Ryan.



The Avengers #213 (Nov. 1981) Captain America charges Yellowjacket recklessness. (Cover by Bob Hall and Dan Green)



The Avengers #200 (Oct. 1980) Temporal anomalies plague New York as Ms. Marvel gives birth to a son who reaches adulthood within mere hours. (Cover by George Perez and Terry Austin).



The Avengers #300 (Feb. 1989) The Avengers celebrate 300 hundred issues with the introduction of a new team. (Cover by John Buscema and Tom Palmer)

The Avengers #273 (Nov. 1986) The Marvel Universe celebrates its 35th Anniversary with a series of dramatic portrait covers. (Cover by John Buscema and Tom Palmer)



The Avengers #192 (Feb. 1980) Iron Man and Wonder Man visit the Steel City. (Cover by George Perez and Joe Sinnott)



The Avengers Annual #10 (1981) Rogue absorbs Ms. Marvel's superhuman powers. (Cover by Al Milgrom)



The Avengers #223 (Sept. 1982) Hawkeye and Ant-Man battle the Taskmaster. (Cover by Ed Hannigan and Klaus Janzon)



The Avengers #243 (May 1984) The Vision is linked with an alien super-computer. (Cover by Al Milgrom and Joe Sinnott)



The Avengers #255 (May 1985) Captain Marvel is kidnapped by space pirates. (Painting by Tom Palmer)



The Avengers #277 (March 1987) Captain America faces a new Baron Zemo. (Cover by John Buscema and Tom Palmer)



The Avengers #288 (Feb. 1988) The Sentry attacks the team. (Cover by John Buscema and Tom Palmer)



The Avengers #302 (April 1989) East and West Coast team against the Super-Nova. (Cover by John Buscema and Tom Palmer)